



CLOUD MIGRATION & FINANCIAL OPTIMISATION

Exiting the On-Premises Data Centre:

Migrating Legacy File Shares to SharePoint Online



Lead Solutions Specialist:
David Liong (MCP, PSM I)



Organisation & Client:
Royal Automobile Club of WA (RAC)
– Insurance Sector



Core Technology Stack:
ShareGate | SharePoint Online | Microsoft Teams
OneDrive | Azure File Storage | PowerShell

Customer Story

At RAC a house brand insurance company for Western Australia, David Liong with a core team of 7 members lead a large-scale digital transformation project of exiting the data centre by delivering cloud migrations from file shares across to SharePoint Online.

The outcome of delivering the entire migration was reducing annual operational expenditure (OpEx) by approximately \$100K (achieved by **reducing operational running costs from \$112K to \$12K per annum when existing the data center on premise**)



A secure, resilient, and cost-effective cloud platform that enables RAC to innovate faster, collaborate better, and serve members with excellence.

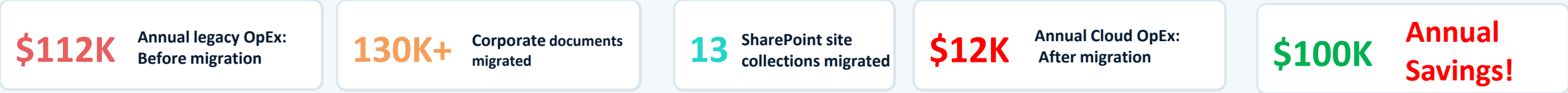
\$100K+ ANNUAL RECURRING SAVINGS – Post migration

130,000+ documents | 13 site collections migrated | zero file loss | 0 P1 incidents



Legacy On-Premises File Shares Imposed High OpEx and Siloed Corporate Data

A costly physical footprint, fragmented content and limited modern collaboration constrained the cloud-first strategy.



2

PROACTIVE INFRASTRUCTURE OPT.



Financial Benefits
Minimising on-premise servers. last refresh lockers, rings and watches the usage cost, RAC over \$120,000 per year.



Future-Focused Infrastructure
Depreciable capital expenditure (CapEx) to operational cost (OpEx) transition – scale infrastructure faster than high latency and ticket rentals cloud futures.



Physical Data Centre Independence
The physical on-premises environment needed for organisations processing sensitive data gradually becomes less advantageous relative to public cloud offered ecosystems.

3

DATA SILOS & OPERATIONAL BLOCKS



Nonstop Content Silos
Over 100,000 seperate documents silo'd in silo directories were trapped in legacy SharePoint 2010 environments and network drives.



Zero Collaboration
Legacy storage solutions modern platforms: version conflicts, no file co-authoring restrictions, and no natural search indexing, and demanded complex local tax laws.



Access & Compliance Limitations
Fragmented access controls specifically with onerous OHS and legally compliant audit trails, compounded risks, and jeopardised data to breach liabilities.

IR lacked mobile responsiveness

PILLAR 3: THE ARCHITECTURAL BLUEPRINT

Engineering Content Staging, Permission Preservation and the Azure SMB Exception

A Governed migration pattern moved modern content to Microsoft 365 while protecting macro-dependent legacy workflows.

CLOUD MIGRATION ARCHITECTURE



Structured Cloud Migration: Successfully mapped and migrated legacy SharePoint 2013 site collections to SharePoint Online modern Communication and Team sites.



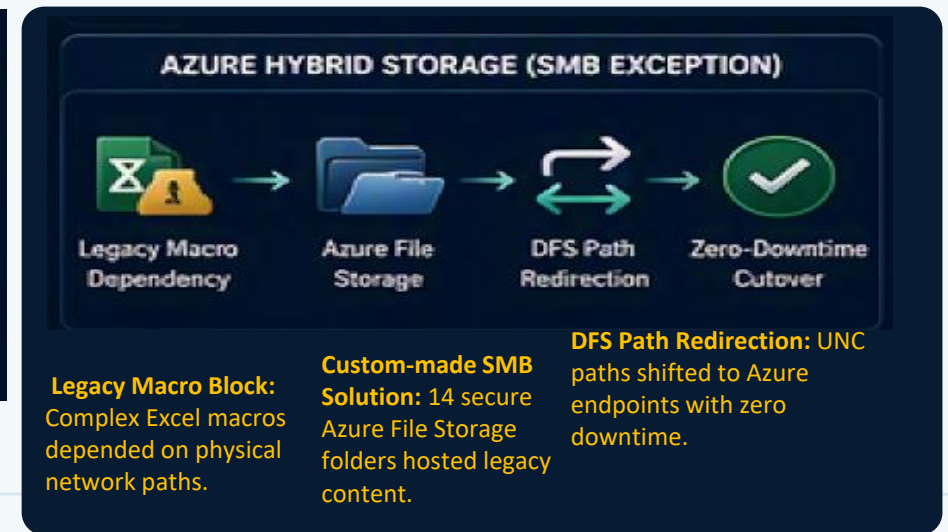
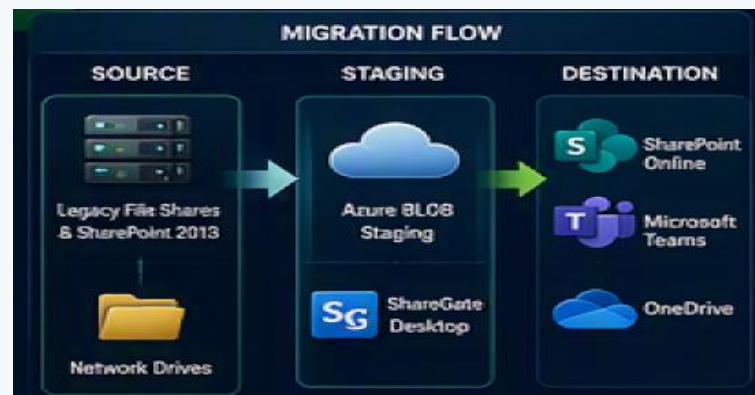
ShareGate Staging Engine: Deployed ShareGate Desktop to execute high-velocity document copies, utilizing temporary Azure BLOB containers as staging environments to bypass API throttling.



PowerShell & PBI Telemetry: Authored custom PowerShell scripts to pre-seed large data sets, and built dynamic Power BI dashboards to track migration velocity, delta changes, and check-out logs.



Data & Permission Integrity: Enforced strict metadata taxonomy mapping, preserved document authors and timestamps, and migrated custom permission models securely.



PILLAR 4: THE ENGINEERING CRAFT

Rigorous Pre-Migration Scans, Agile Backlogs and Service Transition Checklists

A disciplined three-phase SDLC migration processes to achieve protected data integrity, security, delivery velocity and operational readiness.



STRATEGIC MIGRATION PLAN

No content moved without a map, a security baseline, a rollback strategy and an operational handover plan.

Plan → Pre-scan → Build → Test → Delta migration → CAB → Deployment → Handover → Decommission

PHASE 1: DISCOVERY & PRE-SCAN



- ✓ **Taxonomy Workshops:** Facilitated planning sessions with INS stakeholders to map out metadata taxonomy and define Hub-to-Team site hierarchies.
- ✓ **Blocking Analysis:** Conducted exhaustive pre-scans using ShareGate to identify file path lengths, legacy permissions, and checkout file blocks.
- ✓ **Dynamic Rule Backups:** Audited and backed up dynamic Active Directory security groups via Entra ID before any file moving commenced.

PHASE 2: SPRINT RUN & SECURITY



- ✓ **Certified Scrum Master:** Managed the backlog, facilitated retrospectives, and coordinated with stakeholders in daily Agile ceremonies.
- ✓ **Security & Compliance:** Partnered with IAM and Security teams to enforce least-privilege access and validate data residency compliance.
- ✓ **Incremental Testing:** Executed UAT cycles and pilot migrations, validating data accuracy and permission inheritance.

PHASE 3: DEPLOYMENT & HANDOVER



- ✓ **ITIL Change Management:** Authored comprehensive SIDs, CAB approvals, and rollback plans aligned to ITIL standards.
- ✓ **Knowledge Transition:** Created Service Transition checklists, SOPs, and training guides for the Service Desk Team (Level 1 Support).
- ✓ **Hypercare Support:** Provided post-go-live Hypercare support, monitoring adoption and resolving issues proactively.



PILLAR 5: THE BUSINESS TRANSFORMATION

Strategic Outcomes and Business Impact

Delivering financial value (Annual saving of \$100K), operational excellence (85% opex reduction) and future ready collaboration

\$100K+

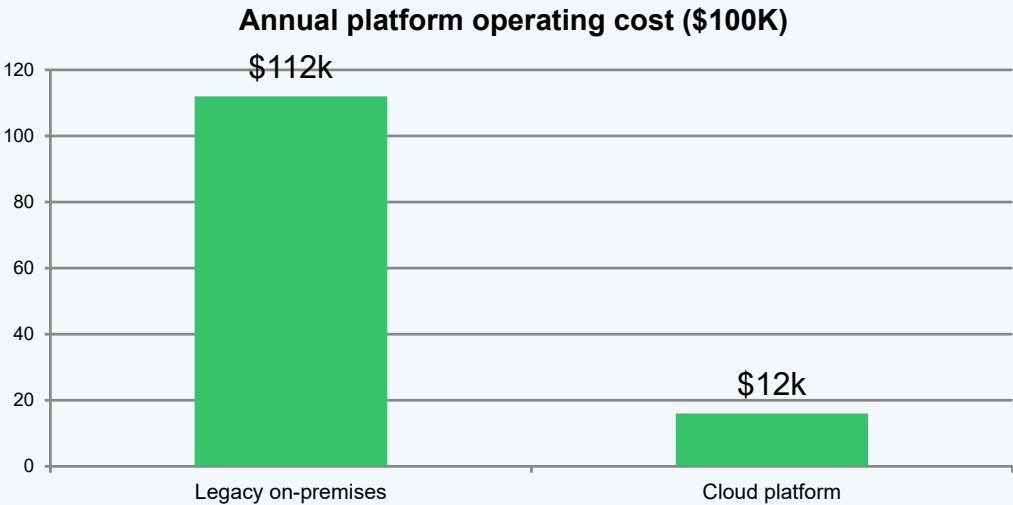
ANNUAL RECURRING SAVINGS

85%

OPEX REDUCTION

100%

DATA INTEGRITY



>\$100K ANNUAL RECURRING SAVINGS
Eliminated physical server, NetApps hosting, and data centre costs.

EXITED ON-PREM DATA CENTRE
Decommissioned legacy infrastructure and achieved RAC's cloud-first strategy.

MODERN COLLABORATION ENABLED
Real-time co-authoring, instant search, version history, and mobile access for the workforce.

ENHANCED SECURITY & COMPLIANCE
Centralised permissions, audit trails, DLP policies, and Data Residency compliance.

PERFORMANCE & SCALABILITY
Delivered high-performance platforms with global scalability and rapid adaptability.

SUSTAINABILITY & CLOUD-FIRST
Reduced carbon footprint and advanced RAC's cloud-first strategy.

130,000+

Documents Migrated

13

Site Collections Migrated

100%

Zero Downtime Cutover

100%

Business User Adoption

Why This Case Study Matters to Future Managers/Employers

This case matters because strategic outcomes align to business & technology goals



Business Aligned
Delivered outcomes that directly support corporate strategies and cost optimisation.



Microsoft 365 Expert
Deep expertise across SharePoint, Teams, OneDrive, Entra ID, ShareGate, and Azure.



Hybrid Problem Solver
Designed innovative Azure SMB solutions to overcome complex legacy application dependencies.



Governance & Risk
Built secure, compliant, and auditable solutions that reduce risk and protect the business.



Proven Delivery
Delivered at scale with Agile, ITIL, and strong stakeholder collaboration.



SECURE
Enterprise-grade security & compliance



SCALABLE
Built to grow with the business



RELIABLE
High availability & zero downtime



SUSTAINABLE
Lower costs, greener future

Role Alignment: How David Liong Adds Value

Solutions Architect



Designs scalable, secure, and cost-effective cloud solutions aligned to business goals.

Microsoft 365 Consultant



Drives adoption of M365 services to boost productivity and collaboration.

SharePoint Migration Lead



Specialises in complex content migrations with zero data loss and minimal risks.

Technical Business Analyst



Bridges business requirements with technical solutions and clear ROI.

Cloud Transformation Lead



Leads end-to-end transformation programs delivering measurable value.